Luke speaks.

Keynotes and conference workshops

Keynotes with Luke Rodgers BEM

From care leaver. To care leader.



Story-led keynotes for conferences, staff days and boards: stories of care from Luke's lived experience, the theory behind them and tools your audience can use the next day.

In person or online
keynotes of up to 90 minutes
or a conference workshop

7
keynotes
or one built for your audience

4,000+
delegates since 2024
from 30 to 400 in a room

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Section 1

The keynotes

Seven talks, each built for a different audience. Or tell us yours and we shape one around them.

The 7 keynotes

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Find the keynote for your audience

A mixed audience	→ **Living a Careless Life**
Foster carers	→ **Just Say Yes**
Social workers	→ **The Power of the Profile**
Schools and colleges	→ **Tools for Schools**
Senior leaders	→ **Lived Experience Leadership**
Care-experienced young people	→ **From Care Leaver to Care Leader**
Employers	→ **Be the First Yes**



Don't see your audience here?

Tell us your conference theme, who's coming and what you want them to leave with, and we'll shape a custom keynote around them. It follows the same approach as every other talk, with the recording, the on-demand course and the workbook included.

1

Keynote 1 of 7

Flagship talk

Living a Careless Life

What it is really like to grow up in care.



Overview

Luke went into care at 10. He shares stories from his own time in care that are moving and often funny, and that show the moments when one adult and one relationship changed what happened next.

Two ideas explain how systems shape the way a child is seen. The first is how profiles and referrals are written: too often they describe a child by what went wrong, and placements and school places are lost because of it. The second is the Two Timetables, where school and social care clash around the child, from reviews held in school to how information is shared.

Your audience leaves knowing how to talk with children, read the message in a behaviour and spot the triggers that can take a child back to trauma, and how much one relationship can do.

By the end, delegates will

- What children in care notice that adults miss
- The moments that build trust, and the ones that break it
- How systems and language can make children feel like a case
- What one adult can change

Best for

Whole services, conferences, schools and corporate parenting boards

2 Keynote 2 of 7

Just Say Yes

Inspiring foster carers to say yes.

Overview

Luke shares stories from his time in foster care: what it felt like to be judged by a profile, to be misunderstood and then believed in, and the moments when a foster carer made a life-changing difference. They show how relationships, not labels, create safety.

Attachment and how early relationships shape behaviour, the impact of trauma on brain development and emotional regulation, and the link between behaviour and survival. It explains why traditional approaches to discipline may not work for children in care.

Simple tools carers can use straight away: reframing behaviour through a trauma-informed lens, ways of talking that build trust and calm conflict, making home feel safe and predictable, and responding to hard moments with empathy, not punishment.



By the end, delegates will

- Understand how profiles shape what carers expect
- Know the basics of trauma, attachment and behaviour as communication
- Respond to hard moments with empathy, not fear
- Leave with simple tools for daily care, and the confidence to say yes

Best for

Foster carers, kinship carers and the fostering teams who support them

3 Keynote 3 of 7

The Power of the Profile

One day, the child will read what you wrote.

Overview

Luke shares what it was like to read his own file: to be introduced through incident logs, and turned down because of paperwork that did not show who he was.

Trauma-informed storytelling, attachment and the psychology of language. A profile is often built from inherited court reports, incident logs and assessments, so the child is described by what went wrong. This explains how those words shape what a school, carer or panel expects before they meet the child.

Practical ways to write profiles that are honest, balanced and hopeful, reframe behaviour so it reduces fear, and help other professionals say yes through the way information is shared. It also recognises the weight social workers carry when the answer is no.



By the end, delegates will

- Write profiles that inspire belief, not fear
- Reframe behaviour through a trauma-informed lens
- Understand the emotional and ethical weight of telling a child's story
- Feel renewed confidence in advocating for a child

Best for

Social workers at every level, team managers, supervising social workers, IROs and students

4

Keynote 4 of 7

Tools for Schools

Read the behaviour, then reach for the right tool.



Overview

Luke shares his own school experiences: what it felt like to be labelled and excluded, and the difference it made when a teacher believed in him. His story helps staff understand the inner world of a child in care.

Trauma, attachment and child development made relevant to the classroom, so staff understand the why behind the behaviour they see. Most teacher training does not cover trauma or children in care, yet schools are expected to be a critical support.

Tools to respond to trauma-based behaviour without escalating it, build safe learning environments where every child can thrive, and talk with children in care in ways that build trust, not fear.

By the end, delegates will

- Read behaviour as communication and respond in the moment
- Know what attachment and trauma look like in school
- Understand how language and stigma shape a child's school life
- Know where school and social care clash, and what to do about it

Best for

Headteachers, designated teachers, teachers and college staff

5 Keynote 5 of 7

Lived Experience Leadership

Young people in service delivery and improvement, with the Five S framework.



Overview

Luke shares his own journey from telling his story to leading national work, and what helped at each stage.

The Five S framework, five stages from first telling a story to leading the work:

1. **Storytelling** sharing their experience safely, on their own terms
2. **Skills** recognising the skills their experience has given them
3. **Strategies** helping shape plans, services and decisions
4. **Scaling** leading pieces of work, such as training staff
5. **Succession** mentoring and bringing the next young people through

Leaders map where the young people in their service are on the five stages, match them to roles in service delivery and improvement that fit their stage, and plan how each young person moves on, and who leads next.

By the end, delegates will

- Know the five stages: storytelling, skills, strategies, scaling and succession
- Recognise where the young people in their service are on it
- Match young people to roles in service delivery and improvement that fit their stage
- Plan how young people move through the stages, and who leads next

Best for

Senior leaders, leadership teams and anyone who works with children

6 Keynote 6 of 7

From Care Leaver to Care Leader

Your story as a strength, not a setback.

Overview

Luke shares his journey from growing up in care to becoming a national leader, speaker and founder. His story shows what is possible for every care-experienced young person.

How the care system shapes identity, how trauma shapes behaviour, and how getting through hard times builds real leadership skills: adapting, solving problems, reading people and keeping going. Young people are often described by other people's words in case notes and plans. This talk helps them tell their own.

Young people reframe their experience as a strength, recognise the skills they already have, and see themselves as people who can lead change in their own lives and beyond.



By the end, delegates will

- See their care experience as a strength, not a weakness
- Recognise the skills they already have
- Feel more confident about their future
- See themselves as people who can lead change

Best for

Care-experienced young people aged 14 and over, children in care councils and care leaver groups

7 Keynote 7 of 7

Be the First Yes

Opening doors for care leavers in the workplace.

Overview

Luke shares his own move from care into work, and how one opportunity changed his future.

The barriers care leavers face in getting and keeping work, often without family networks, references or a safety net, and the behavioural science behind stigma, opportunity and belonging. Care leavers are not asking for special treatment. They are asking for a chance.

Clear steps to make recruitment and induction care-aware, offer mentoring and onboarding that helps people stay, and build teams where care-experienced staff can grow.



By the end, delegates will

- Understand who care leavers are and what support really looks like
- Know how to make recruitment and induction care-aware
- Plan mentoring and onboarding that helps people stay
- Feel confident, not cautious, about being the first yes

Best for

Employers, HR and early careers teams, hiring managers and social value leads

Section 2

What you get

Everything that comes with a booking, and how every keynote is built.

- More than a keynote
- The workbook, online course and video
- Story, theory and action



More than a keynote

Every booking, in person or online, comes with the same four things.



A planning call

Before the day

- A 30-minute planning call
- The keynote shaped around your audience and theme
- A title and blurb for your programme, plus Luke's photo and bio



The keynote

On the day

- A keynote of up to 90 minutes
- Time for questions and discussion
- The slides, to share with delegates



A workbook for every delegate

On the day

- Print-ready or digital
- Activities for individuals and teams
- Theirs to keep



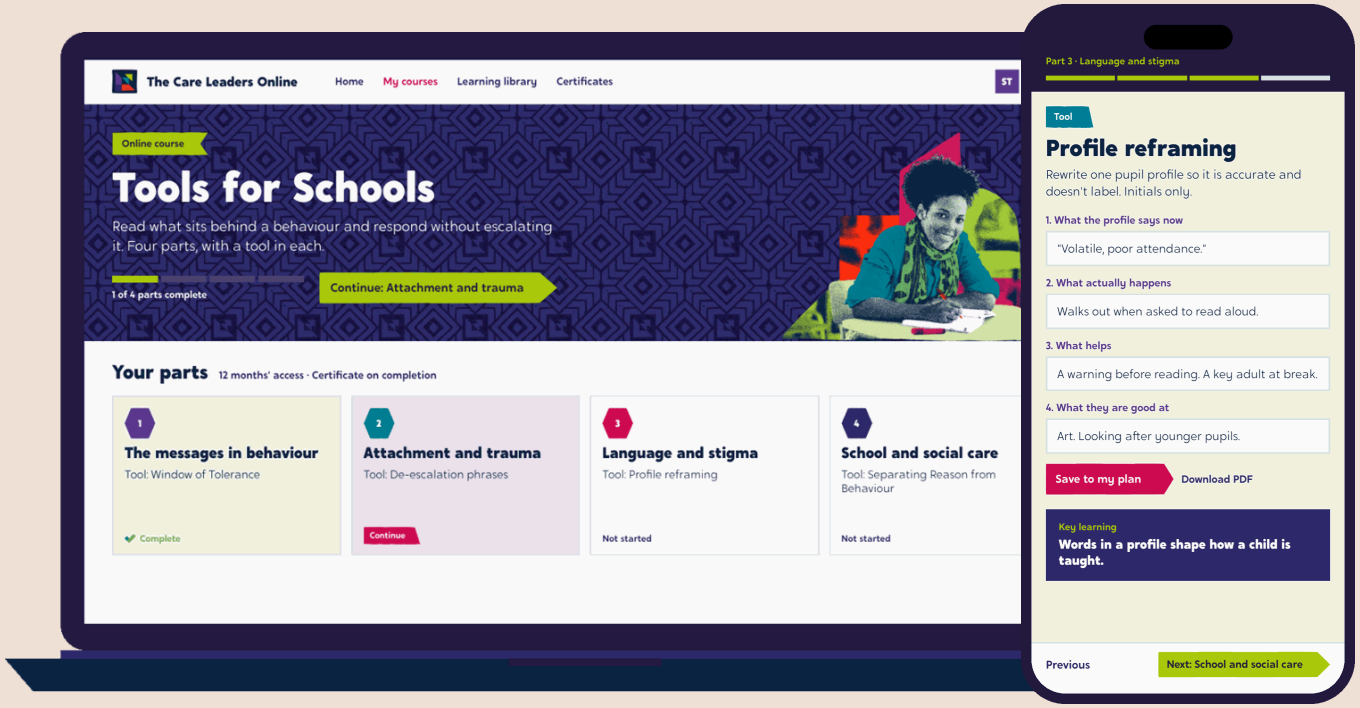
The recording and course

After the day

- The full keynote recorded
- An on-demand course on The Care Leaders Online
- 12 months' access for every delegate

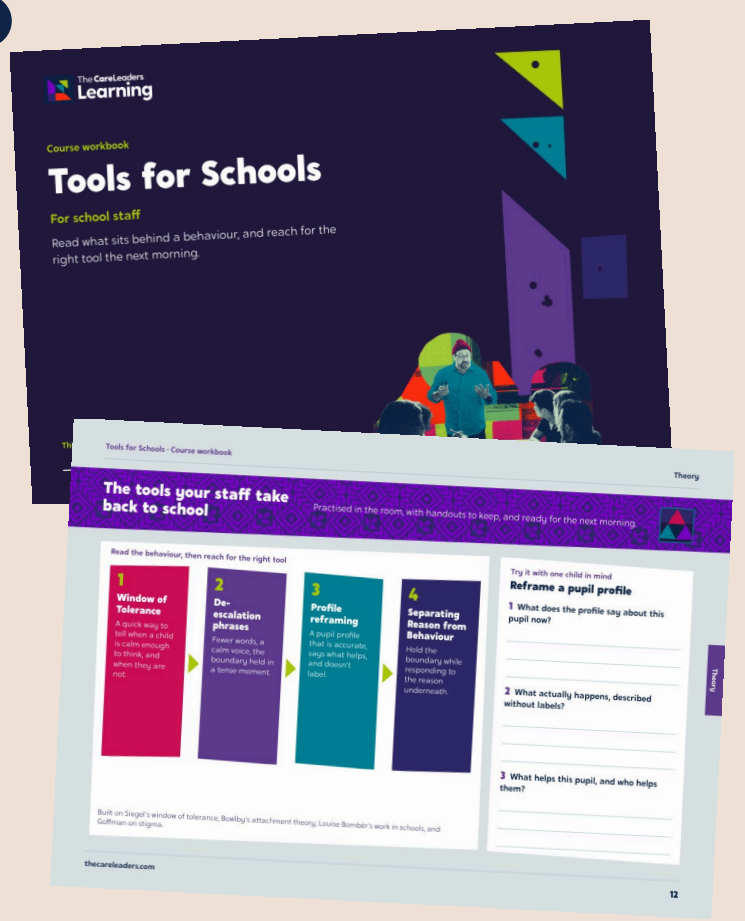
Workbook, online course and video

With every keynote: free for 12 months



The online course on a laptop

Every tool works on a phone



The workbook, theirs to keep

Shown: Tools for Schools, one of the 7 keynotes. Every keynote has its own workbook, online course and video.

How we teach: Story, Theory, Action

Every Care Leaders course, keynote, workbook and online lesson follows the same three steps.



Story

A real moment from care, told from the young person's side.



Theory

The thinking that explains it, with honest evidence.



Action

Something to practise and use at work the next day.

Every time

Stories of care from Luke's lived experience, the theory behind them, and tools your audience uses the next day.

Section 3

About Luke

Who gives the keynote, and why organisations book him.

- Your speaker: Luke Rodgers BEM
- Why book Luke





From care leaver to care leader

Your speaker

Luke Rodgers BEM

Luke went into care at 10. He has spent his career inside children's services as a consultant, trainer and keynote speaker, and is CEO of The Care Leaders.

He has worked with councils nationally, including Durham County Council, where he put NVR into 11 children's homes and trained 120 residential staff, online and face to face.

He led the national engagement on England's new fostering standards for the Department for Education.

He is a former Knowledge Equity Fellow at Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, and was awarded the British Empire Medal in 2018 for commitment to children and families.

Luke gives every keynote himself, in person or live online, and stays for questions.

On stage

45+ keynotes since the start of 2024

4,000+ delegates have heard Luke speak since 2024

400 people in the largest single room so far

"You demand bravery and humanity in equal measure."

Maggie Atkinson, former Children's Commissioner for England

Why book Luke

Keynotes from someone who has lived in care and has led services.

Lived and professional experience

Founded and led by Luke Rodgers BEM, a care experienced leader. Every course is written by people who have been in care and people who have run, redesigned and inspected children's services. Your team hears both sides.

Inside national policy

We led the national engagement on England's new fostering standards for the Department for Education. Our training reflects what the standards expect.

Learning that carries on after the day

A workbook for life, the recording and 12 months online. Your team keeps going back to it.

Honest about the evidence

We say what the research shows, and where it is still limited.

Award winning

iESE Awards GOLD Winner 2026
The Public Sector Transformation Awards

Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award
iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026

Children & Young People Now Awards 2023 Winner

Workforce Development Award
Children & Young People Now Awards 2023

36 local authorities we have worked with, plus the Department for Education and the NHS

2,700+ learners on The Care Leaders Online

Section 4

Fees and booking

What it costs, and how to book.

- Fees for every keynote
- Book Luke in 4 steps



Fees for every keynote

In person

Keynote

Up to 90 minutes, at your event



£4,950 + VAT + travel expenses

- A planning call before the day
- A workbook for every delegate
- The recording and course for 12 months

Live online

Keynote

Up to 90 minutes, on Teams or Zoom



£2,490 + VAT

- A planning call before the day
- Questions in the chat and live Q&A
- The recording and course for 12 months

Keynotes and conference workshops are contracted and invoiced by Luke Speaks Ltd, powered by The Care Leaders. If Luke is free, we hold your date for 14 days.

Book Luke in 4 steps

1

Tell us about your event

The date, your audience and the talk

2

Get availability and a fee

We hold the date for 14 days

3

Confirm by email

And send a purchase order if you use them

4

Before the day

A planning call and a checklist

hello@thecareleaders.com